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GETATTRIBUTE() VS INPUTVALUE()

Getting Element Properties in Playwright

In web automation, we often need to **read values** from elements - like getting a placeholder text, reading an attribute, or fetching what user typed in a textbox.

Playwright gives us TWO important methods for this: **getAttribute()** and **inputValue()**

! IMPORTANT!

getAttribute('value') does NOT work for getting entered text! Use **inputValue()** instead!

Understanding HTML Attributes

Sample Email Input Field:

```
<input  
  type="text"  
  name="email"  
  id="input-email"  
  placeholder="E-Mail Address"  
  class="form-control"  
>
```

Common HTML Attributes:

- **name** = "email"
- **id** = "input-email"
- **placeholder** = "E-Mail Address"
- **class** = "form-control"
- **type** = "text"

Method 1: `getAttribute()`

Use `getAttribute()` to get ANY HTML attribute value (except the entered value!)



Syntax

```
let attributeValue = await locator.getAttribute('attributeName');
```

Example 1: Get 'name' Attribute



Code Example

```
let name = await page.locator('#input-email').getAttribute('name');  
console.log(name);  
// Output: "email"
```

Example 2: Get 'placeholder' Attribute



Code Example

```
let placeholder = await page.locator('#input-email').getAttribute('placeholder');  
console.log(placeholder);  
// Output: "E-Mail Address"
```



More `getAttribute()` Examples:

```
// Get type attribute
let type = await element.getAttribute('type');    // "text"

// Get class attribute
let className = await element.getAttribute('class'); // "form-control"

// Get id attribute
let id = await element.getAttribute('id');        // "input-email"

// Get href (for links)
let url = await link.getAttribute('href');        // "https://..."

// Get src (for images)
let imgSrc = await image.getAttribute('src');     // "image.png"
```

Method 2: `inputValue()`

Use **`inputValue()`** to get the ENTERED text in input fields!



Syntax

```
let enteredText = await locator.inputValue();
```



Complete Example

```
// Step 1: Enter text in the field
await page.locator('#input-email').fill('naveen@gmail.com');

// Step 2: Get the entered value
let enteredVal = await page.locator('#input-email').inputValue();
console.log(enteredVal);
// Output: "naveen@gmail.com"
```



When to use inputValue()?

- ✓ *To verify what user typed in a textbox*
- ✓ *To validate form field values*
- ✓ *To get current value of input/textarea elements*
- ✓ *For assertions in tests*

The KEY Difference!



This DOESN'T Work:

```
// ❌ WRONG! This returns null or empty string
await page.locator('#input-email').fill('naveen@gmail.com');
let value = await page.locator('#input-email').getAttribute('value');
console.log(value); // ❌ Won't work!
```

Why? Because the 'value' attribute in HTML doesn't update when user types!

✅ *This DOES Work:*

```
// ✅ CORRECT! Use inputValue()
await page.locator('#input-email').fill('naveen@gmail.com');
let value = await page.locator('#input-email').inputValue();
console.log(value); // ✅ "naveen@gmail.com"
```

Perfect! inputValue() gets the actual entered text! 🎉

Quick Comparison

Aspect	<code>getAttribute()</code>	<code>inputValue()</code>
Purpose	Get HTML attributes	Get entered text value

Aspect	<code>getAttribute()</code>	<code>inputValue()</code>
Works For	<i>name, id, class, placeholder, href, src</i>	<i>input, textarea fields ONLY</i>
Syntax	<code>getAttribute('name')</code>	<code>inputValue()</code>
Returns	<i>string / null</i>	<i>string</i>
Use Case	<i>Static HTML properties</i>	<i>Dynamic user input</i>



REMEMBER!

- `getAttribute()` for static HTML attributes (name, id, placeholder, etc.)
- `inputValue()` for entered/typed text in input fields
- `getAttribute('value')` does NOT work for entered text!

Real World Example



Login Form Validation:

```
await page.goto('https://naveenautomationlabs.com/opencart/');

let emailField = page.locator('#input-email');
```

```
// Get placeholder text (static attribute)
let placeholder = await emailField.getAttribute('placeholder');
console.log('Placeholder:', placeholder);
// Output: "E-Mail Address"

// Get the name attribute (static attribute)
let name = await emailField.getAttribute('name');
console.log('Name:', name);
// Output: "email"

// Enter email
await emailField.fill('naveen@gmail.com');

// Get the entered value (dynamic input)
let enteredEmail = await emailField.inputValue();
console.log('Entered Email:', enteredEmail);
// Output: "naveen@gmail.com"

// Validate the email
if (enteredEmail === 'naveen@gmail.com') {
    console.log('✅ Email validation passed!');
}
```

Common Use Cases

- Use `getAttribute()` for:

- ✓ Reading placeholder text
- ✓ Getting element's id, name, class
- ✓ Fetching link URLs (href attribute)
- ✓ Getting image sources (src attribute)
- ✓ Checking element type
- ✓ Reading any custom data attributes

● Use `inputValue()` for:

- ✓ Validating user-entered text
- ✓ Getting form field values
- ✓ Verifying auto-filled data
- ✓ Assertions in test cases
- ✓ Reading textarea content

✗ COMMON MISTAKES

- × Using `getAttribute('value')` to get entered text
- × Forgetting `await` keyword (both are async!)

- × Using `inputValue()` on non-input elements
- × Not handling null values from `getAttribute()`
- × Confusing static attributes with dynamic values

★ PRO TIPS!

- 💡 Always use `inputValue()` for form validations
- 💡 `getAttribute()` can return null - handle it properly!
- 💡 Use `getAttribute()` for data-* custom attributes
- 💡 Combine both methods for complete element validation
- 💡 Remember: Static attributes vs Dynamic values!

✨ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- `getAttribute()` reads static HTML attributes
- `inputValue()` reads dynamic entered text
- `getAttribute('value')` does NOT work for user input!

→ Both methods are async - always use await

→ Choose the right method for your use case! 🎯

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